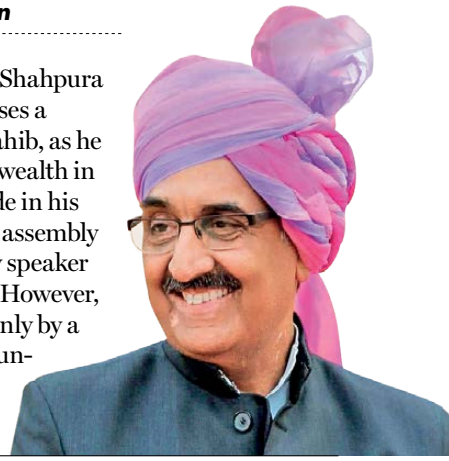
Photograph by **BANDEEP SINGH**



RAO RAJENDRA SINGH, *66* ▼

| BJP | *Jaipur Rural, Rajasthan*



The Bishangarh Fort this Shahpura royal inherited now houses a luxury hotel. But Rao Sahib, as he is popularly known, takes his wealth in his stride, and takes more pride in his speeches and interventions in assembly debates. He has been a deputy speaker there and a three-term MLA. However, his parliamentary win came only by a whisker—a slim 1,615 votes—unlike the lush royal moustache Rao Sahib sports.



▲ MALVIKA DEVI, *44*

| BJP | *Kalahandi, Odisha*

What does it mean to be queen in a place that was once called the 'land of hunger'? It strengthens your zeal to do better for your people, as Rani Maa strives to do. A Himachal royal married into the Kalahandi royal family, this psychology graduate from Jesus & Mary College in Delhi joined the BJP in 2023 along with her husband Arka Keshari Deo. Deo was earlier with the BJD and represented Kalahandi from 2014 to 2019. As Rani Maa takes forward the family legacy, she hopes to bring education and jobs to Kalahandi.

KRITI DEVI DEBBARMAN, *53* ▶

| BJP | *Tripura East (ST), Tripura*

A member of the Manikya dynasty, she is the sister of Pradyot Manikya Debbarma, the current titular king of Tripura. Though her brother is the founding head of the Tipra Motha Party, an ally of the ruling BJP in the state, she contested the election as a joint candidate on the saffron party's lotus symbol. Married to Yogeshwar Raj Singh of Chhattisgarh's Kawardha royal family, Kriti has a diploma in rural management from the Institute of Rural Management, Anand, and has been involved in environmental conservation and sustainable development in the Northeast, focusing on water management and rural projects.



-Ajay Sukumaran, Dhaval S. Kulkarni, Rohit Parihar, Kaushik Deka and Arkamoy Datta Majumdar